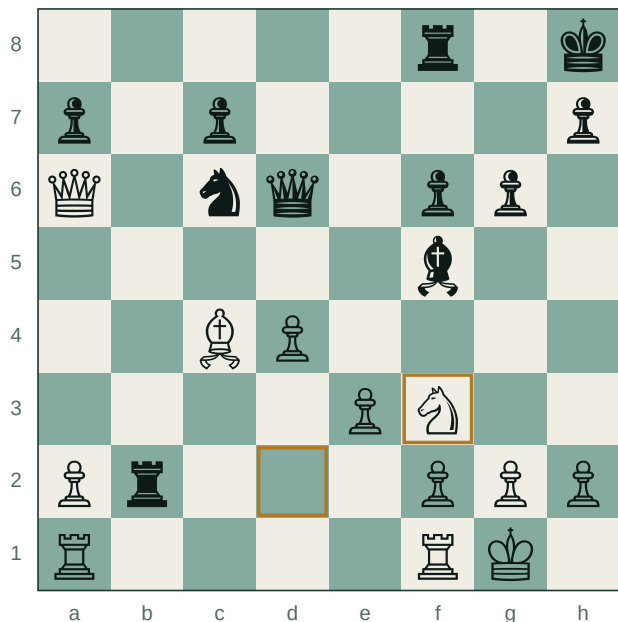


Interference tactics: Black, move 19

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Nf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...Rb6 20. Qa4 Rb4 21. Qd1 Rxc4

19...Rb6 The rook moves from b2 to b6. Recorded reply: **20.Qa4**.

20...Rb4 The rook moves from b6 to b4. From b4 it attacks queen on a4 and bishop on c4. Recorded reply: **21.Qd1**.

21...Rxc4 The rook captures the bishop on c4.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.